

NAME

man2pdf – compile raw roff manual pages into high-fidelity PDFs

SYNOPSIS

man2pdf <path_to_manpage_file>

DESCRIPTION

man2pdf is an automation utility that ingests a raw UNIX manual source file (**roff** format) and compiles it into a universally accessible PDF document.

The tool automatically handles filename parsing, extracts the base utility name, ensures the destination directory exists, and invokes the system compiler layout engine to generate a pristine, cross-platform publication format matching classic UNIX manual conventions.

THE SCRIPT

This manual entry documents the following standalone shell script:

```
#!/bin/bash
if [[ -z "$1" ]]; then
    echo "Usage: man2pdf <path_to_manpage_file>"
    exit 1
fi
MAN_FILE="$1"
FILENAME=$(basename "$MAN_FILE")
BASE_NAME="${FILENAME%.*}"
mkdir -p man-pdf
groff -man -Tpdf "$MAN_FILE" > "man-pdf/BASE_NAME}.pdf"
```

DEPENDENCIES

This script relies directly on the **groff** document formatting system. It must be installed and available in the current environment's **\$PATH**.

Checking for Groff:

You can verify its presence using your refined visibility tool: *which groff*

MacOS Installation:

If missing on a Mac environment, install it via Homebrew: *brew install groff*

DIAGNOSTICS

Returns 0 on successful compilation. Returns 1 if no input file is specified, or if the underlying **groff** compiler encounters an execution error.

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